Strategy on a page

The aim: run KOR **like a Fortune 500 company** in BD, financials, operations and IT, on tools built for it (Part 4). This page: where KOR should play, how it wins, and what Operations must fix. **Every choice is a recommendation** for you and the partners; every number comes from KOR's own record.

WHERE WE STAND

Four numbers that set the agenda

$367k / month
invoiced Apr–Sep 2026, down from $490k Oct–Mar. The firm is billing a quarter less.

43%
of submitted proposals won since 2020. 72% of decided ones, but 266 were never closed out.

$1.41M
owed over 90 days, of $2.26M. Each 30 days off DSO frees about $423k.

0 of 110
live pursuits carry a fee estimate, so the pipeline has no dollar value yet.

Read together: **less work is coming in, what is won is slow to turn into cash, and the pipeline cannot yet say what is coming next.** Jim and JM expect a quiet market until January and then a rush. The plan below uses the quiet months to fix the process, so the rush lands on a working system.

YOURS, NOT THE SYSTEM'S

What you and the partners decide

- **The goals and their numbers.** The figures above are starting points from KOR's record, not commitments.
- **Which repeat developers each partner owns,** and who qualifies the low-converting clients.
- **The $805k on inactive projects.** 31103-01 alone is $502k, last invoiced February 2024.
- **Whether the US gets more than Jim's time.** It holds 17 of the 110 live pursuits and one person sells it.

HOW SURE EACH NUMBER IS

Win rates come from the 701-pursuit fee tracker, 2020–2026. "Never closed" means no Deltek job appeared within 180 days; that test found a job for 249 of 266 known wins and for 6 of 478 known losses. Sector win rates are left out because lost proposals carry no reliable sector. Money figures are the Financials engine's, read by this morning's brief.

Sources: docs/KOR-Management-Win-Loss-2026-10-18.md (tracker win/loss, clients, regions, fee bands, loss reasons); the morning brief of 19 October 2026 (Financials engine: AR, aging, over budget, utilization, invoiced and collected by month, DSO; live pursuits from the CRM); docs/KOR-Impact-Scoreboard-2026-10-18 (targets); the 9 October BD meeting (market read and cadence).

RECOMMENDATION · YOU DECIDE

Strategy

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Win more of the right work, earlier

WHERE TO PLAY

- **Grow the developers who already choose KOR.** Westland, Northland, Cressey, Domus, Kerkhoff and Polygon: 40 won, 1 lost.
  Each gets a named partner and a standing check-in, not a proposal-by-proposal relationship.
- **Metro Vancouver and South of Fraser are the base.** 220 of 281 wins since 2020; South of Fraser converts 81% of decided proposals.
- **The US is the growth market.** 22 wins at 65% decided, and 17 of 110 live pursuits, all Jim's.
- **Qualify hard before writing a fee for the clients who rarely convert.** NSDA, Wesgroup, Strand, Starlight and Porte: 12 won, 15 lost, 35 never decided.
  A go/no-go before the proposal, not after.

HOW KOR WINS

- **Get in as the architect's engineer before the RFP.** The structural engineer is usually chosen at the start of schematic design.
- **Mid-size fees convert best.** $25–100k wins 80% of decided; $250k and up wins 58%. Big bids are deliberate bets.
- **Close every proposal.** Follow up at 14 days, chase the decision at 45, and record who won and why. Glotman Simpson is the competitor named most often (6 of the stated losses).
- **Spread the selling.** One principal leads 345 of 701 pursuits (49%). Six owners now hold the 110 live pursuits.

GOALS TO 31 MARCH 2027 · NUMBERS YOURS TO SET

- Every live pursuit has a fee estimate and an owner's next step (today 0 of 110 have a fee).
- No proposal sits "submitted" past 60 days without an outcome.
- Submitted-to-won from 43% toward 50%.
- Invoicing back above $400k a month.

OPERATIONS

Turn work into cash, and stop giving hours away

WHERE IT HURTS

- **Cash.** $2.26M owed, $1.41M of it over 90 days, and $805k on projects no longer on the active list.
- **Overruns.** 272 of 814 active projects are over their hours budget; 72 are critical; 94 are burning hours faster than they bill.
- **Capacity.** Utilization is 70.8%.

PRIORITIES

- **Collect.** A partner owns every invoice over 90 days and reports at the quickie. Decide the $805k on inactive projects: collect, settle or write off.
- **Charge for changes before the hours are spent.** Extra-service letters on the worst ten over-budget projects first.
- **Bill on time.** Close the gap on the 94 projects where billing lags the hours.
- **Fix the process before January.** The rush should land on a working cadence, not a backlog.

GOALS TO 31 MARCH 2027 · FROM THE SCOREBOARD

- DSO from 174 to 120 days: about **$760k of cash** without billing a dollar more.
- Owed over 90 days under $700k.
- The $805k inactive AR decided, with the reason recorded.
- Over-budget projects down from 272, the worst ten with change orders.

THE REST OF THE PLAN

Parts 2 to 4

- **Part 2, the whole process on one page:** signal, pursuit, proposal, win, delivery, invoice, cash, with each stage's owner, its measure, and the part of the system that serves it.
- **Part 3, the rhythm:** the daily hour, the weekly roll-ups and the monthly meetings, each tied to a goal above, so every task traces back to this page.
- **Part 4, the platform:** the BD apps, Financials, Operations and IT tools that watch, prepare and draft, so a firm of sixty works like a Fortune 500 company.

The whole process

From the first sign of a project to cash in the bank: eight stages, who owns each one, how it is measured today, what the system does for it, and **where the chain breaks**.

ONE CHAIN, TWO HALVES

Signal to cash

1 Signal → 2 Pursuit → 3 Proposal → 4 Decision → 5 Won or lost → 6 Delivery → 7 Invoice → 8 Cash

Orange is business development, slate is Operations. The BD half decides **how much work comes in**; the Operations half decides **how much of it becomes cash**. Part 1's goals sit on this chain: invoicing back above $400k a month needs the left half, $760k of cash from faster collection needs the right.

Where it breaks today

Pursuit → Proposal

None of the 110 live pursuits carries a fee estimate, and 61 have not been touched in 14 days or more, so nobody can say what the pipeline is worth.

Proposal → Decision

266 proposals since 2020 were sent and never closed. Win rate is 72% when a client decides, 43% of everything sent.

Invoice → Cash

174 days to collect. $1.41M is over 90 days, $805k of it on projects no longer active.

OWNER · MEASURE · WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The eight stages

1 Signal

WHAT	Permits, rezonings, tenders and news about the people KOR works with.
OWNER	The radar finds; the regional lead picks.
TODAY	1,731 new in 30 days, from 128 of 140 sources. Only you see them so far.
SYSTEM	Nightly ingestion, the relevance gate, client dossiers in the Director.
NEXT STEP	Release the app to the leads (the pilot for Omar, Islam and Jim, promised on 9 October), so each lead sees the signals in their region and makes the good ones pursuits.

2 Pursuit

WHAT	A named project or client with an owner and a next step.
OWNER	Regional lead: Omar Vancouver, Islam Alberta, Conor Okanagan, Rory Island, Jim US; JM.
TODAY	110 live; 0 carry a fee; 61 untouched for 14 days or more.
SYSTEM	The CRM, and a weekly roll-up per owner: first touch by day 7, keep warm every 21 days, next step when due.
WEAK POINT	Calls and meetings are rarely logged, so most items read "first touch".

3 Proposal

WHAT	Go or no-go, then the fee proposal (filed in Project Opportunities\Pending).
OWNER	The lead, with the engineer who will run the job.
TODAY	None of the 110 live pursuits is a tender, so no go/no-go is on record.
SYSTEM	For tenders: go/no-go 2 days after it opens, draft review a week before the deadline, submission check 2 days before.
WEAK POINT	Questions deadlines and addenda are not captured, so the system cannot warn on them.

4 Decision

WHAT	Chasing the client until they decide.
OWNER	The lead.
TODAY	43% of sent proposals won; 266 never closed. Leduc was closed as a no-bid on 16 October because its submission was never recorded.
SYSTEM	Follow-up at 14 days, chase the decision at 45, both in the owner's roll-up.
WEAK POINT	The win/loss review found no standing close-out step before this month.

5 Won or lost

WHAT	Won: hand the job to delivery. Lost: who won, and why.
OWNER	The lead, handing to the project manager.
TODAY	Of 291 lost or unanswered proposals with a comment, fewer than 30 say why.
SYSTEM	Hand-off and loss-reason asks within 30 days, in the roll-up.
WEAK POINT	Loss reasons are what Part 1's "how KOR wins" should learn from, and they are mostly missing.

6 Delivery

WHAT	Designing the job inside its fee.
OWNER	The project manager (12 PMs, 814 active projects); JM and Jim in the COO seat.
TODAY	272 over their hours budget; 72 critical; utilization 70.8%.
SYSTEM	The Financials engine, the COO monthly, the COO moves in your morning hour.
WEAK POINT	Proposed: an extra-service letter before a project passes its hours budget, tracked as a step, not found afterwards.

7 Invoice

WHAT	Billing what has been earned, on time.
OWNER	The project manager.
TODAY	$367k a month, April to September; 94 projects bill slower than they burn hours.
SYSTEM	The billing-lag list from the Financials engine, in the morning brief.
WEAK POINT	Proposed: the billing-lag list is reviewed at each PM's quickie, not only read by you.

8 Cash

WHAT	Collecting what has been billed.
OWNER	Proposed: a named partner for every invoice over 90 days.
TODAY	174 days to collect; $2.26M owed; $1.41M over 90 days.
SYSTEM	The scoreboard records it every morning; the COO monthly pre-read lists the largest.
WEAK POINT	The collections module is barely built, so chasing is by hand.

Sources: CRM and ingestion counts read 19 October 2026 (opportunities.Opportunities, CrmEngagements, OpportunitySources); docs/KOR-Management-Win-Loss-2026-10-18.md; the morning brief of 19 October (Financials engine); the pursuit touchstone rules (migration 371).

The rhythm

The daily hour, the weekly roll-ups and the meetings, each tied to a goal in Part 1 and a stage in Part 2, so **every task you do traces back to the plan**. About six hours of your week.

DAY · WEEK · FORTNIGHT · MONTH · QUARTER

What happens when, and what it moves

RHYTHM	WHO · WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	MOVES (PART 1 GOAL)	STAGES
Daily hour	You. Email at 6:05 on weekdays; the same hour in the Director.	Ranked BD, COO and IT moves, drafts ready to send, the roll-ups due to forward.	All of them: it is where the plan becomes today's work.	1–8
Pursuit roll-ups	You forward; each pursuit owner replies. Every 7 days, sooner when something is urgent.	Numbered asks (Do, By, Why). One line back per item: done, moved, or dropped and why.	Every pursuit has a next step; no proposal past 60 days without an outcome.	2–5
Monday lists	You, to each lead, with Monday's email.	Each lead's open actions from the meetings, as drafts.	Actions closed faster than they open (0 of 31 closed today).	2–5
Quickie, regional lead	You with Omar, Islam, Conor, Rory. 15 min every two weeks; first is Omar, Tue 20 Oct, 10:00.	Their roll-up replies, their top three pursuits, one ask.	A fee estimate on every pursuit; submitted-to-won toward 50%.	1–5
Quickie, BD + COO	You with JM and Jim. 20 min every two weeks, from the week of 26 Oct.	Their pursuits, then their projects over budget and invoices over 90 days.	Invoicing above $400k a month; over 90 days under $700k.	2–8
BD monthly	Leads and JM. 27 min; first Fri 13 Nov, 2:00.	What closed, what is late by owner, one topic (first: closing out every fee).	Close every proposal; submitted-to-won.	2–5
COO monthly	JM and Jim. 27 min; first Thu 29 Oct, 9:00.	Cash and collections, projects losing hours, timesheets, three decisions.	Collection time from 174 to 120 days; the $805k decided; over-budget down.	6–8

RHYTHM	WHO · WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	MOVES (PART 1 GOAL)	STAGES
Quarterly review	You and the partners. Proposed: first in January 2027.	Part 1 against the scoreboard: goals hit or missed, where to play, what to change.	Keeps the plan true.	All

> **THE SCOREBOARD IS THE THREAD**
>
> The scoreboard records the money and pipeline numbers every morning. The daily hour reads it, each monthly meets with its change, and the quarterly review judges the plan by it. A task that moves none of its numbers should not be in the rhythm.

ONE TASK, END TO END

How a roll-up item traces back to the plan

GOAL · PART 1
No proposal sits "submitted" past 60 days without an outcome.

STAGE · PART 2
4, Decision: follow up at 14 days, chase at 45.

RHYTHM · PART 3
The owner's weekly roll-up: "Do: ask for a decision date. By: Friday. Why: sent 14 days ago."

MEASURE
Their reply closes the item; the scoreboard's won and lost totals move when the client decides.

The same chain runs for Operations: goal "over 90 days under $700k", stage 8, the COO monthly's ask to JM on 31103-01, measured by the scoreboard's over-90 line.

HONEST GAPS

Not built yet

- **Open fees do not reach the roll-ups yet.** The fee tracker's unanswered proposals enter the CRM with the import's second step, which waits on your review of the 45 unclear rows. Until then the roll-ups cover the 110 CRM pursuits only.
- **The app in the leads' hands.** The pilot for Omar, Islam and Jim, with a one-page how-to, so the signals reach the people who pursue them.
- **Questions deadlines and addenda** on tenders are not captured.
- **The monthly scoreboard page** (what changed in dollars) and **the quarterly review** are proposed, not built.
- **The book knowledge is a snapshot** from mid-October; a regular refresh is not scheduled.

Sources: docs/KOR-Meeting-Rhythm-Samples-2026-10-18 (cadence and first dates); the pursuit touchstone rules (migration 371); the morning brief of 19 October 2026 (open actions, scoreboard); docs/KOR-Impact-Scoreboard-2026-10-18.

The platform

The tools being built so a firm of about sixty runs **like a Fortune 500 company** in business development, financials, operations and IT. The system watches, prepares and drafts; people decide and act.

WHY BUILD IT

Big-company discipline without big-company overhead

A Fortune 500 company runs on market intelligence, a managed pipeline, a finance office that watches cash daily, operations reviews, and IT that is monitored rather than repaired. KOR cannot hire those departments. It can build the tools that do most of their work, on its own data, and put the result in front of the person who has to act.

WATCH
Every source, every night: tenders, permits, Deltek, the CRM, every PC and server.

PREPARE
Ranked, with the evidence and KOR's own record behind each item.

DRAFT
The email, the agenda, the roll-up, ready to send.

DECIDE
A person reads it and acts. Nothing goes out on its own.

WHAT EXISTS · WHAT IT HAS FOUND · WHAT IS NEXT

Four pillars

BD Business development apps

F500 HAS	A CRM, market intelligence, a bid desk, win/loss review.
KOR HAS	The BD Director (your daily hour, drafts, meetings); the early-signal radar on 128 sources; the CRM with stages and weekly owner roll-ups; client dossiers; a knowledge library of 44,446 findings from BD books and KOR's own documents.
FOUND	1,731 new signals in 30 days. KOR's real win/loss record, rebuilt from 4,785 past pursuits: 72% when a client decides, 43% of everything sent.
NEXT	The app in the leads' hands (pilot: Omar, Islam, Jim); open fees into the CRM; tender questions and addenda.

$ Financials

F500 HAS	A finance office: daily cash, receivables, backlog, project margins, a monthly close.
KOR HAS	The Financials module and Executive Summary across all 814 active projects (cash, AR aging, backlog, over-budget, delivery risk, utilization); the impact scoreboard, recorded every morning since 18 October.
FOUND	$805k owed on projects no longer active, $502k of it on one job last invoiced in February 2024. Invoicing down a quarter in six months. Each 30 days off collection time is about $423k of cash.
NEXT	Collections: the module is barely built, so chasing is by hand. The monthly scoreboard page.

OPS Operations

F500 HAS	Operations reviews, resource planning, project controls, a standard way of working.
KOR HAS	The COO brief in your daily hour; PM workload and timesheet completeness; over-budget and billing-lag lists; project tools for the engineers (email filing, transmittals, standard details, drawing-to-model tools).
FOUND	272 of 814 active projects over their hours budget, 72 critical, 94 billing slower than they burn hours.
NEXT	Extra-service letters tracked as a step; the COO monthly from 29 October.

IT IT

F500 HAS	Monitoring on every device, patching on schedule, a service desk, backups that are tested.
KOR HAS	NetworkOps, KOR's own fleet control: health of every PC and server, rack, UPS and firewall monitoring, updates, remote fixes, and the IT moves in your daily hour.
FOUND	84 open issue groups today, 6 critical (failing or missing drives); 35 machines missing October's security patches (16 October).
NEXT	Patch the 35; the backup path and server reboots already planned; retire any paid tool the platform now replaces.

THE COST LINE

Because of NetworkOps, KOR's own monitoring, patching and remote-support platform, outside IT spend comes down to five things: **antivirus, Veeam backups, Office 365, connectivity and phones.** Everything else (fleet monitoring and remote support, the CRM, market intelligence, financial reporting, the daily brief) is built and owned by KOR, so it costs no licence fees and fits how KOR works.

FROM THE SYSTEM TO A PERSON

How it reaches people

- **You:** the daily hour at 6:05, by email and in the Director, with BD, COO and IT moves ranked and drafted (Part 3).
- **Pursuit owners:** the weekly roll-up you forward, then the app itself once the pilot starts.
- **JM and Jim:** the COO monthly pre-read and their quickie, built from the Financials engine.
- **Everyone, later:** nothing reaches the team directly until you decide it should. Today every draft opens unsent in your Outlook.

THE RULE THE PLATFORM KEEPS

Each number is read from the source system (Deltek, the CRM, the fleet), never retyped, and shown with where it came from. Judgement is written in a working session and recorded, so the reasoning behind a recommendation can be checked.

Sources: knowledge library and CRM counts read 18–19 October 2026; docs/KOR-Management-Win-Loss-2026-10-18.md; the morning brief of 19 October (Financials engine, NetworkOps open findings); NetworkOps patch status of 16 October.